

Tiny Bodies, Big Brains — Module 03: Perception — Think About It

Part A: Family Discussion Questions

1. Which sense would you miss the most if you lost it? (Sight? Hearing? Touch?).
2. Why do some people need glasses? (The eye system needs a helper to focus properly).
3. Can you hear sounds that your parents cannot? (Yes! Young ears can hear higher pitches).
4. Why do some foods smell amazing to you but gross to your sibling? (Different brains, different models!).
5. What is an "optical illusion"? (When your brain predicts wrong about what it sees).
6. How do your senses work together? (You see the pizza AND smell it AND feel the warmth).
7. Why do bright lights hurt your eyes when you come out of a dark room? (Your eyes need time to adjust their settings).
8. What is "proprioception"? (Your body's sense of where it is in space — try closing your eyes and touching your nose!).
9. Can you think of a time your senses tricked you? (Thinking you heard your name, seeing a shape in the dark).
10. Why do babies put everything in their mouths? (Mouth is one of their best sensors for exploring!).

Part B: Hands-On Activities and Reflection

1. Do a "Super Senses" challenge: Close your eyes and have someone make different sounds (clapping, snapping, tapping). Can you identify each sound and where it comes from?
2. Make a "Texture Board": Collect five different textures (sandpaper, cotton, foil, fabric, leaves). Blindfold a partner. Can they identify each texture by touch alone?
3. Try the "Nose Knows" test: Blindfold yourself and have someone hold different items near your nose (orange peel, cinnamon, soap). How many can you identify by smell?

4. Stare at a colorful picture for 30 seconds, then look at a white wall. Do you see an "afterimage"? Your visual system is still processing!
5. Play "Sound Safari" in your yard or house. Sit quietly for two minutes and list every sound you hear. How many sounds were you not aware of before you listened carefully?
6. Test your taste buds: Hold your nose closed and eat a jellybean or piece of fruit. Can you tell what flavor it is without smell? Taste and smell are partners!
7. Try touching your nose with your eyes closed. Now try touching your elbow with your other hand, eyes still closed. That is proprioception — your body knows where it is!
8. Look at an optical illusion together. Discuss: Why does the brain get tricked? (Because it predicts based on patterns, and illusions break the pattern).
9. Make a "Sensory Diary" for one day: Write down the most interesting thing each sense noticed (best sight, best sound, best smell, best touch, best taste).
10. At bedtime, lie quietly and notice what each sense is telling you. What do you see, hear, feel, smell? Your senses never stop working, even when you are almost asleep.